

6 June 2026

## Greetings from the President

IAESTE Japan



At the 59th Board of Directors meeting of IAESTE Japan held in June 2026, I was elected and assumed the position of President, succeeding Makoto Yamamoto. This association is responsible for promoting the international growth and harmony of young people in Japan and around the world, systematically while valuing each individual. I am once again deeply aware of this great responsibility. I intend to do my best to further develop the activities of this association. I would like to ask for the continued support and encouragement of all members.

I myself worked at a television company in Mexico City for about three months during the summer of my first year of graduate school as my IAESTE internship opportunity. It was the year that IAESTE Mexico was established. If I were to start talking about the details, there would be no end to it, but I spent each day happily, while feeling nervous, as I was constantly discovering different cultures and ways of thinking. This experience greatly changed my outlook on life afterward and has become a very precious treasure to me. Every IAESTE internship program is customized for individual, and he/she lives a life where his/her individual judgment at each moment is of great importance. This is different from a pre-arranged stay through an exchange agreement prepared by universities. Even after 40 years, I continue to maintain contact with former student committee members and company people of the host country, which fills me with happiness.

These days, it is said that more and more people attach importance to cost-effectiveness and time-efficiency, and that more companies prioritizing immediate contributions, with the world becoming a harsher place. The international community is also changing, becoming increasingly volatile in recent years. At such times, IAESTE is determined to contribute even more significantly to long-term human growth and international exchange in everyday life. We will strive to further expand this circle.

I sincerely ask for your continued support.

Akira Hirose, President